IIT KANPUR

GLIDO LABS

FOUNDER'S OFFICE

STRATEGY ASSIGNMENT

BHAGAVAD GITA DAILY

Monetization & Growth Strategy

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THE THESIS

Not a product or audience problem.

A funnel + monetization-depth problem — both fixable in 90 days.

MAPPING THE FUNNEL FAILURE — WHY 2.2% CONVERTS WHEN INDUSTRY CONVERTS 8–12%

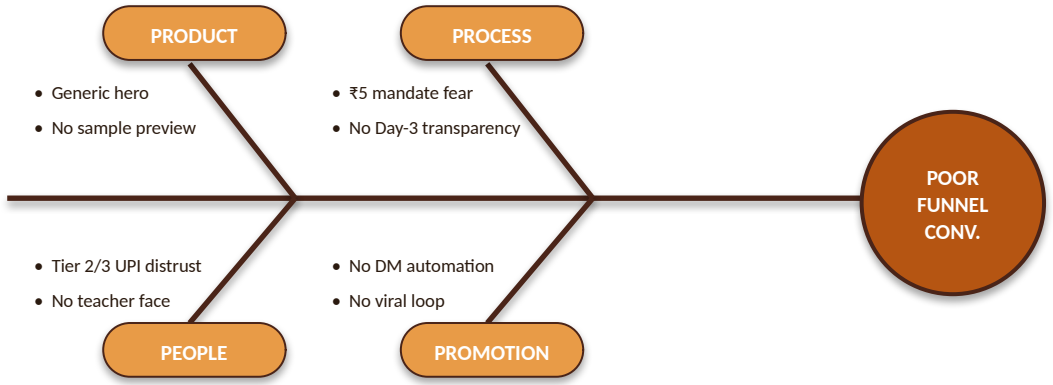
ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS — 5 WHYS METHOD

PROBLEM: 192K loyal followers, ₹79 product, 116 paying users — yet only 2.2% of website visitors convert. Funnel collapses at every step.

WHY ARE VISITORS NOT SUBSCRIBING?	Homepage tries to be a marketing site, a Gita resource hub AND a subscription page. Avg scroll 51.95%, form below the fold.
WHY DO USERS NOT START THE TRIAL?	₹5 UPI mandate scares spiritually-motivated tier 2/3 users unfamiliar with auto-deductions; no plain-language explainer at checkout.
WHY DO TRIAL USERS CHURN ON DAY 3?	47 of 163 (29%) cancel — Day-3 charge is a surprise; 3 days is too short to feel value; no transparency before deduction.
WHY DON'T FOLLOWERS BECOME SUBSCRIBERS?	Instagram serves the same shlok content for free; no visible value gap between the free and paid product.
WHY IS GROWTH NOT COMPOUNDING?	No DM automation, no daily Reels engine, no viral loop in WhatsApp messages — top of funnel grows linearly, not exponentially.

ROOT CAUSE · Funnel was built for users who already trust the brand. It must be re-built for users who must be earned.

FISHBONE (ISHIKAWA) ANALYSIS — FUNNEL FAILURE



KEY TAKEAWAY · Failure is structural across all 4 levers — not a single silver-bullet fix.

VALUE PROPOSITION CANVAS — THE MODERN SEEKER

PRODUCT (GAIN CREATORS)

- 8 AM daily WhatsApp shlok
- Meaning + life-application
- 3-day taste-test trial
- Annual lock-in (₹699)
- Premium community (₹199)

JOBS-TO-BE-DONE

Anchor my morning ·
Make sense of life events ·
Feel connected daily ·
Pass tradition forward

PILLAR 1 STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY · The funnel breaks because product, process, people and promotion all fail at the same point — earning trust before asking for ₹79.

EXECUTIVE FRAMEWORK — TRUST EQUATION ADAPTED FOR DAILY SPIRITUAL SUBSCRIPTIONS

TRUST = (CREDIBILITY + RELIABILITY + INTIMACY) ÷ SELF-ORIENTATION

PILLAR 1 · PSYCHOLOGICAL TRUST

PRE-CLICK

Earn the click before asking for the rupee.

STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE

Reframe the brand from "another spiritual page" to "the one daily ritual you set your morning by."

MECHANISM

Hero rewrite: "One shlok every morning on WhatsApp — explained for your life today." Real founder/scholar face on homepage. Single social-proof number used everywhere.

OUTCOME

Homepage → Form lifts from 18% → 30%+ in 30 days. Zero new spend.

PILLAR 2 · TRANSACTIONAL TRUST

AT-CHECKOUT

Make ₹5 mandate feel like a handshake, not a hostage.

STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE

Replace silent friction with bilingual transparency. Treat the mandate as a conversation, not a contract.

MECHANISM

Hindi+English mandate explainer · Razorpay logo · "Cancel anytime" badge · one real testimonial · WhatsApp opt-in confirmation immediately after submit.

OUTCOME

Form → Trial lifts from 17% → 30%+. A/B test removing ₹5 mandate entirely.

PILLAR 3 · EXPERIENTIAL TRUST

POST-PAY

Earn the next 11 months in the first 3 days.

STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE

Day-3 charge must feel like a milestone, not a surprise. Trial is not a test — it is the product.

MECHANISM

Day 1/2/3 WhatsApp arc: welcome → preview → pre-charge transparency. Re-engagement WhatsApp 48h after cancellation. "Reply STOP" radical opt-out.

OUTCOME

Trial → Paid lifts from 71% → 88%+. 47 churned users get a 15–20% reactivation.

PILLAR 2 STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY · Trust is not a feature; it is the product. Each pillar reduces a different fear, at a different moment, in a different language.

FROM 2.2% TO 8%+ — THE THREE LEAKS, THE FIX-ORDER, THE EXPECTED IMPACT

FUNNEL DIAGNOSTIC — TODAY VS BENCHMARK

STAGE	TODAY	CONV.	BENCHMARK	STATUS
Instagram → Website	192K followers	2.7%	5–8%	CRITICAL
Homepage → Form visit	5,239 → 952	18.2%	35–45%	CRITICAL
Form visit → Trial	952 → 163	17.1%	40–55%	CRITICAL
Trial → Paid	163 → 116	71.2%	80–90%	IMPROVE
Paid → Retained (30-day)	116 active / 47 churned	71.2%	85–92%	IMPROVE

THREE LEAKS · THREE ROOT CAUSES · THREE FIXES

LEAK 01

Homepage → Form · 82% drop

ROOT · Page does too much. Form below the fold. Generic hero.

FIX · Single-purpose page · form above fold · sample message preview.

LEAK 02

Form → Trial · 83% drop

ROOT · ₹5 UPI mandate scares spiritually-motivated users.

FIX · Bilingual mandate explainer · trust badges · A/B remove mandate.

LEAK 03

Trial → Paid · 29% churn

ROOT · Day-3 charge surprises users; <3 days of value.

FIX · Day 1/2/3 WhatsApp arc · pre-charge transparency · 48h re-engage.

TRIAL ACTIVATION ARC — A 3-DAY WHATSAPP SEQUENCE THAT EARNS THE ₹79 CHARGE

1 — SIGN-UP (T = 0)
Instant WhatsApp: "Your Gita journey starts tomorrow at 8 AM 🙏."

2 — DAY 1 (8 AM)
First shlok + permission to explore. "For 3 days, this is completely free."

3 — DAY 2 (8 AM + 7 PM)
Shlok + evening preview of next 5 shlokas. Annual upsell teaser appears here.

4 — DAY 3 (PRE-CHARGE)
"Trial ends today. ₹79 will be charged. Reply STOP to cancel."

5 — CANCEL? (T + 48H)
Re-engagement WhatsApp: "Your spot is still here." 15–20% reactivation.

PILLAR 3 STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY · 88% of every leak sits in steps 2 and 3. Fixing them costs ₹0 in ad spend, takes 30 days, and 4–5x's revenue at constant traffic.

TARGET CAC < ₹150 · TARGET K-FACTOR > 1.2 · THE 5-CHANNEL ACQUISITION MATRIX

THE 5-NODE CHANNEL EFFICIENCY MATRIX

STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE Reaching 25 trials/day requires 9× ToFu lift. We sequence 5 channels by cost and conversion mechanic — never run paid until the funnel converts > 8%.

ACQUISITION CHANNEL	STRATEGIC MECHANISM & MESSAGING	BUDGET	TARGET CAC
DM AUTOMATION (INSTAGRAM)	ManyChat "GITA" comment trigger → auto-DM with form link. Caption every post with the trigger.	0%	₹0 (ORGANIC)
DAILY REELS + SHORTS	1 Reel/day on "Gita for [anxiety / exam / heartbreak]". Cross-post YouTube Shorts for older buyers.	0%	₹0 (ORGANIC)
MICRO-CREATOR COLLABS	20–30 spiritual creators (100K–500K). 30-day free trial for their audience. Barter or revenue-share.	15%	₹40
WHATSAPP VIRAL LOOP	Every daily message: "Forward to someone who needs this 🙏". Shareable short link.	5%	₹0 (ORGANIC)
META CTWA · AFTER MONTH 2 ONLY	Click-to-WhatsApp ads. Lookalike of paid base. Hindi spiritual interests. T1+T2 cities.	80%	₹150

BLENDED CAC OUTCOME · Weighted average lands at ~₹125 — well below ₹150 target. 80% organic mix is structurally cheap.

DUAL VIRAL LOOPS · K > 1.2

STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE Every 10 acquired subscribers must organically generate 12+ more.

LOOP A · WHATSAPP FORWARD-LOOP

Daily message ends with "Forward to someone who needs this 🙏". 116 active users + 28 days = 3,248 send-touches/month.

LOOP B · CREATOR-AUDIENCE BORROW

30-day free trial offered to micro-creator audiences. One collab → 500–1,000 trials at zero CAC.

FINANCIAL SYNTHESIS · PER-SUB UNIT ECON

Revenue per subscriber/year	₹948
Annual prepay (avg blend)	₹699
Blended CAC	₹125
Payback period	1.6 mo
LTV @ 8% monthly churn	₹987
LTV / CAC (Y1)	7.9×

TRUE CONTRIBUTION · ₹823/sub Y1

PILLAR 4 STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY · This acquisition engine is structurally cheap (80% organic), demand-elastic (creators), and self-reinforcing (forward loop).

FROM ONE ₹79 SKU TO A FULL MONETIZATION STACK — HABIT × LOYALTY × DEPTH

HOOK MODEL (NIR EYAL) — RE-ENGINEERING THE MORNING RITUAL

STRATEGIC IMPERATIVE Make the 8 AM shlok feel like coffee — non-negotiable, ritualistic, missed when absent. Habit-based products have the lowest churn in subscription.

TRIGGER	ACTION	REWARD	INVEST
8 AM WhatsApp arrives. Phone vibrates with familiar sender.	User opens. 30 seconds to read shlok + meaning.	Small variable insight — "this happens to be exactly what I needed today."	User reflects, screenshots, forwards to a friend → builds attachment.

↻ *THE LOOP COMPOUNDS · Each completed cycle deepens habit and reduces churn*

3-TIER LOYALTY LADDER

- **ELITE · Annual prepay + premium community**
- **INSIDER · PDF guides + Day-30 retention**
- **MEMBER · ₹79/mo daily WhatsApp shlok**
- **FREE · Instagram + sample shlok**

MONETIZATION STACK · 6 STREAMS · POST-MONTH 3 BLENDED ₹1.92L+/MONTH

TIER	PRODUCT	PRICE	GO-LIVE	MONTHLY @ SCALE	STRATEGIC ROLE
FREE	Instagram content + sample shlok	₹0	Now	**Acquisition layer**	Top of funnel — feeds every paid tier
CORE	Daily WhatsApp shlok (monthly)	₹79/mo	Now	**₹63,200 (800 users)**	Anchor SKU, defines the ritual
ANNUAL	Daily WhatsApp (annual prepay)	₹699/yr	Month 1	**₹34,950 (50 users)**	Cuts churn to ~0%, upfront cash
DIGITAL	Situation PDF guides (5 topics)	₹99–149	Month 1	**₹14,850**	Zero-COGS upsell from existing posts
PREMIUM	WhatsApp community + scholar Q&A	₹199/mo	Month 3	**₹19,900 (100 users)**	Gates community, drives status
PHYSICAL	108-card Gita wisdom deck	₹599–699	Month 4	**₹29,950 (50 units)**	Festival gifting, brand artefact
ENTERPRISE	Corporate Gita Daily for teams	₹5K–15K/mo	Month 5	**₹30,000 (3 clients)**	B2B halo + B2C credibility loop

PILLAR 5 STRATEGIC TAKEAWAY · ₹79 is the entry-point, not the ceiling. Monetization depth + habit retention = ₹1.92L+ blended monthly revenue at scale.

UNIT ECONOMICS, COHORT MATH & THE PATH TO ₹1 LAKH MRR BY MONTH 3

87%
GROSS MARGIN PER SUB

₹125
BLENDED CAC

3 MONTHS
TO ₹1 LAKH MRR

₹1.92L+
MONTHLY REV AT SCALE

₹699/YR
ANNUAL PREPAY SKU

PER-SUBSCRIBER UNIT ECONOMICS

LINE ITEM	AMOUNT	RATIONALE
Revenue / sub / year	+₹948	*12 × ₹79*
WhatsApp + payment fees	−₹95	*~10% of revenue*
Content production (alloc.)	−₹30	*1 scholar contract / 800 subs*
Tech + infra	−₹12	*ManyChat, hosting*
GROSS MARGIN	+₹811	*85.5% — exceptional for solo SKU*
Blended CAC (amortized Y1)	−₹125	*Weighted ad+organic mix*
Refund / chargeback reserve	−₹15	*Conservative 2% allowance*
TRUE CONTRIBUTION (Y1)	+₹671	*85.5% gross margin survives CAC*

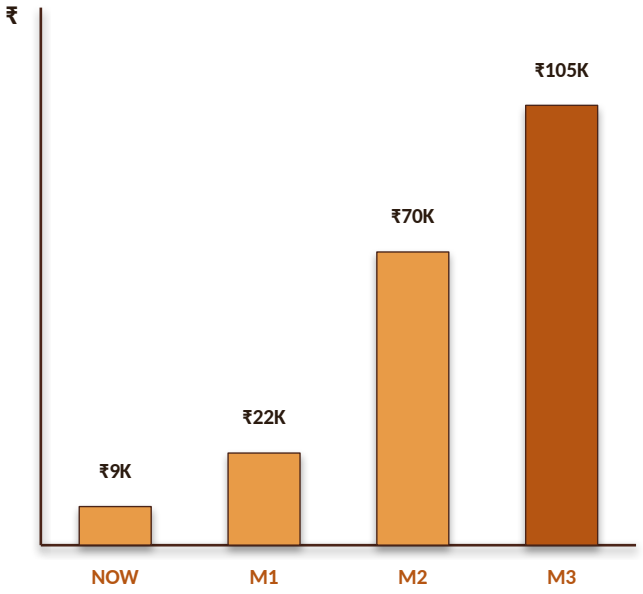
LTV / CAC SENSITIVITY (BY MONTHLY CHURN)

MONTHLY CHURN	AVG LIFE (MO)	LTV	LTV / CAC
5%	20	₹1,580	12.6×
8%	12.5	₹987	7.9×
12%	8.3	₹655	5.2×
20%	5.0	₹395	3.2×
29% (today)	3.4	₹268	2.1×

READ-OUT

Halving churn from 29% → 12% triples LTV. Every 1pp of monthly-churn reduction pays back ad-spend the very next month. The Day-3 trial fix (Pillar 3) is the highest-ROI single intervention in this deck.

MRR PROJECTION · 90 DAYS



Blended monthly revenue (incl. annual + PDF + premium)

90-DAY EXECUTION SEQUENCE · KPI DASHBOARD · RISK & MITIGATION

90-DAY EXECUTION ROADMAP — SEQUENCED FOR ZERO-SPEND COMPOUNDING FIRST

WK 1–2
FIX THE LEAK

Homepage redesign
Form above fold
Mandate explainer

WK 2–3
SEAL THE TRIAL

Day 1/2/3 WhatsApp
Re-engage 47 churns
Pre-charge transparency

WK 3–4
DM AUTOMATION

ManyChat trigger
Update captions
First Story poll

MONTH 2
NEW REVENUE

Annual ₹699 launch
3 PDF guides live
Gift sub page

MONTH 3
SCALE CONTENT

Daily Reels
2 creator collabs
B2B pitch deck

MONTH 3+
PAID ACQUISITION

Meta CTWA ₹500/d
Lookalike audience
Weekly CAC review

MEASURABLE SUCCESS METRICS · KPI DASHBOARD

CATEGORY	KPI	NOW	DAY-30	DAY-60	DAY-90
FUNNEL HEALTH	Homepage → Form rate	18.2%	30%	35%	40%+
FUNNEL HEALTH	Trial → Paid rate	71.2%	78%	82%	88%+
ACQUISITION	Daily new trials	2–3	8–10	15–18	20–30
ACQUISITION	Blended CAC	—	₹0	₹80	<₹150
RETENTION	Monthly churn	29%	<20%	<12%	<8%
REVENUE	Active paid subscribers	116	230	480	800+
REVENUE	Blended monthly revenue	₹9.2K	₹22K	₹70K	₹1.0L+
BRAND	Daily Retained Reads (NSM)	—	—	Track	60%+

RISK & MITIGATION MATRIX

RISK	IMPACT	MITIGATION
WhatsApp policy / API ban	CRITICAL	Move to WhatsApp Business API + email mirror
Mandate distrust → chargebacks	HIGH	Bilingual explainer, pre-charge transparency
Founder content fatigue	MED	Onboard 2 contributing scholars by Month 3
Instagram algo dependency	HIGH	Diversify to Shorts, ShareChat. Email backup
Premium community quality dilution	MED	Hard cap at 150 members, founder moderation

FINAL TAKEAWAY · Fix the funnel before scaling it. Deepen monetization before buying traffic. ₹1 Lakh blended MRR by Month 3 is achievable if Lever 1 lands in 30 days.

APPENDIX

FRAMEWORKS USED

5 WHYS METHOD	Root cause identification of funnel collapse at every step
FISHBONE (ISHIKAWA)	Mapping structural causes across product, process, people, promotion
VALUE PROPOSITION CANVAS	Mapping Bhagavad Gita Daily product to The Modern Seeker JTBD
TRUST EQUATION (MAISTER)	Adapted: Trust = (Credibility + Reliability + Intimacy) ÷ Self-Orientation
HOOK MODEL (NIR EYAL)	Re-engineering the 8 AM shlok as a non-negotiable habit
AARRR PIRATE METRICS	Acquisition / Activation / Retention / Referral / Revenue mapping
UNIT ECONOMICS MODEL	Per-sub P&L: ₹948 → ₹671 true contribution at 85.5% gross margin
LTV/CAC SENSITIVITY	Monthly churn 5% → 29% scenarios across 5 cases
TAM / SAM / SOM	₹4,000 Cr → ₹400 Cr → ₹50–80 L Y1 for the corporate B2B opportunity
KPI DASHBOARD	8 metrics × 4 milestones (now / 30 / 60 / 90 days)
RISK & MITIGATION MATRIX	5 risks with impact rating and named mitigation owner
90-DAY EXECUTION ROADMAP	6 phases sequenced as ZERO-SPEND → REVENUE → SCALE → PAID

SOURCES & DATA REFERENCES

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF
Glido Labs case data — 192K followers, 5,239 visitors, 952 form views, 163 trials, 116 paid, 47 churned

BENCHMARK DATA
Spiritual / wellness subscriptions converting 8–12% — internal benchmark

BENCHMARK DATA
Click-to-WhatsApp ads convert 3–5× higher than website ads — Meta India

INDUSTRY
Indian corporate wellness market sized at ₹4,000 Cr, 15% CAGR — Mercer India 2024

PRODUCT FRAMEWORK
Razorpay UPI mandate UX guidelines; ManyChat Instagram automation conversion data

CONSUMER
Hindi-first spiritual audience preferences; tier-2/3 UPI auto-pay distrust signals

UNIT ECONOMICS
Sequoia India Subscription Unit Economics Guide — LTV/CAC framework

HABIT DESIGN
Nir Eyal — Hooked: How to Build Habit-Forming Products

TRUST FRAMEWORK
Maister, Green, Galford — The Trusted Advisor (Trust Equation)

STRATEGY
Eric Ries, The Lean Startup — Build/Measure/Learn loop applied to funnel fixes

DETAILED FINANCIAL VALIDATION • 12-MONTH COHORT PROJECTION

BHAGAVAD GITA DAILY • 12-MONTH P&L PROJECTION (₹)

METRIC	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6	M7	M8	M9	M10	M11	M12	FY
REVENUE BUILD													
Active subscribers (EOM)	116	180	280	410	560	720	880	1,020	1,170	1,330	1,500	1,700	**1,700**
Core MRR (₹79 × subs)	₹9.2K	₹14.2K	₹22.1K	₹32.4K	₹44.2K	₹56.9K	₹69.5K	₹80.6K	₹92.4K	₹1.1L	₹1.2L	₹1.3L	**₹7.8L**
Annual prepay revenue	—	₹12.0K	₹18.0K	₹25.0K	₹28.0K	₹32.0K	₹35.0K	₹38.0K	₹42.0K	₹46.0K	₹50.0K	₹55.0K	**₹3.8L**
PDF guides revenue	—	₹8.0K	₹12.0K	₹14.0K	₹15.0K	₹15.5K	₹16.0K	₹16.5K	₹17.0K	₹17.5K	₹18.0K	₹18.5K	**₹1.7L**
Premium community revenue	—	—	₹8.0K	₹14.0K	₹16.0K	₹18.0K	₹20.0K	₹22.0K	₹23.0K	₹24.0K	₹25.0K	₹26.0K	**₹2.0L**
Corporate B2B revenue	—	—	—	—	₹10.0K	₹20.0K	₹30.0K	₹35.0K	₹40.0K	₹50.0K	₹60.0K	₹70.0K	**₹3.1L**
TOTAL REVENUE	**₹9.2K**	**₹34.2K**	**₹60.1K**	**₹85.4K**	**₹1.1L**	**₹1.4L**	**₹1.7L**	**₹1.9L**	**₹2.1L**	**₹2.4L**	**₹2.7L**	**₹3.0L**	**₹18.4L**
COSTS													
Cost of goods sold (~13%)	₹-1.2K	₹-4.4K	₹-7.8K	₹-11.1K	₹-14.7K	₹-18.5K	₹-22.2K	₹-25.0K	₹-27.9K	₹-31.5K	₹-35.3K	₹-39.5K	**₹-2.4L**
Gross profit	**₹8.0K**	**₹29.8K**	**₹52.3K**	**₹74.3K**	**₹98.5K**	**₹1.2L**	**₹1.5L**	**₹1.7L**	**₹1.9L**	**₹2.1L**	**₹2.4L**	**₹2.6L**	**₹16.0L**
Ad spend (Meta CTWA + collabs)	—	₹-5.0K	₹-10.0K	₹-12.0K	₹-15.0K	₹-18.0K	₹-20.0K	₹-22.0K	₹-24.0K	₹-26.0K	₹-28.0K	₹-30.0K	**₹-2.1L**
Fixed OPEX (tools + scholar)	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	₹-25.0K	**₹-3.0L**
EBITDA	**₹-17.0K**	**₹-229**	**₹17.3K**	**₹37.3K**	**₹58.5K**	**₹80.9K**	**₹1.0L**	**₹1.2L**	**₹1.4L**	**₹1.6L**	**₹1.8L**	**₹2.1L**	**₹10.9L**

Illustrative projection. Assumes Pillar 1 funnel fixes land in Month 1, paid acquisition activates in Month 3+, B2B contracts begin Month 5.

THE BIG BET

Fix the funnel before you scale it.

Deepen monetization before you buy traffic.

Most spiritual subscriptions die buying ads into broken funnels. We will not. The 90-day plan is sequenced so the first ₹0 of new spend earns the right to the next ₹1 of paid acquisition.

WHAT WE WILL HAVE BY MONTH 3

FUNNEL	Homepage → Trial above 8%, Trial → Paid above 88%
AUDIENCE	800+ active paying subscribers (vs 116 today)
REVENUE	₹1.0L+ blended MRR — 11× current
STACK	Annual, PDF guides, premium community live
PIPELINE	3 corporate pilots in motion · paid ads ROAS-positive
BRAND	200K+ Instagram, first PR mention as India's daily Gita ritual

FROM THE GITA · CHAPTER 2, VERSE 47

"You have a right to perform your prescribed duty, but not to the fruits of action."

Operating principle: ship the funnel; the MRR will follow.